



JKH Counselling Privacy Policy

Effective date: 01 July 2026

Review date: 01 July 2027

This privacy policy will be reviewed annually, or sooner if there are changes to how JKH Counselling collects, stores, or uses personal information.

At JKH Counselling, your privacy is very important. This Privacy Policy explains how I collect, use, store, and protect your personal information when you contact me, use this website, or engage in counselling sessions with me.

I am committed to handling your personal information respectfully, securely, and in line with UK data protection law, including the UK General Data Protection Regulation and the Data Protection Act 2018.

1. Who I Am

JKH Counselling provides counselling and therapeutic support to individuals from a range of backgrounds.

For the purposes of data protection law, the data controller is:

JKH Counselling

Counsellor: Jaspal Kaur Heer

Email: contact.jkhcounselling@gmail.com

Address/Location: Gravesend

ICO registration number: ZB664674

Professional body membership: BACP 00965473

As the data controller, I am responsible for deciding how your personal information is collected, used, stored, and protected.

2. What Personal Information I Collect

I may collect and process the following types of personal information:

Personal details

This may include:

- Your name
- Date of birth
- Address
- Email address
- Phone number
- Emergency contact details
- GP details, where appropriate
- Preferred method of contact



Counselling-related information

This may include:

- Information you choose to share during enquiries, assessments, or counselling sessions
- Session notes or brief clinical notes
- Presenting issues or reasons for seeking counselling
- Relevant personal history
- Risk-related information, where necessary
- Goals for therapy
- Attendance records
- Communication between sessions, where relevant

Special category data

Counselling may involve processing sensitive personal information, known as special category data. This may include information relating to:

- Mental health and emotional wellbeing
- Physical health
- Ethnic or cultural background
- Religious or spiritual beliefs
- Sexuality or relationships
- Family circumstances
- Trauma or difficult life experiences

I only collect information that is relevant and necessary for providing safe, ethical, and appropriate counselling support.

3. How I Collect Your Information

I may collect information when you:

- Contact me through the website contact form
- Email, phone, text, or message me
- Book an initial consultation or counselling session
- Complete an assessment, intake, or client agreement form
- Attend counselling sessions
- Make payments
- Use this website

I may also receive information from third parties, but only where relevant and appropriate, for example from a GP, another healthcare professional, a safeguarding agency, or someone you have given permission to contact me.

4. Why I Use Your Personal Information

I use your personal information to:

- Respond to enquiries
- Arrange appointments



- Provide counselling services
- Assess whether counselling is suitable and safe
- Maintain appropriate counselling records
- Manage payments, invoices, and accounts
- Communicate with you about sessions
- Meet legal, ethical, professional, and insurance obligations
- Safeguard you or others where there is a serious risk of harm
- Improve the website and client experience
- Respond to complaints, legal claims, or professional enquiries

5. Lawful Basis for Using Your Information

Under UK data protection law, I must have a lawful reason for using your personal information.

Depending on the situation, I may rely on the following lawful bases:

Purpose	Type of data	Lawful basis
Responding to enquiries	Contact details and enquiry information	Legitimate interests
Booking and providing counselling	Personal and counselling information	Contract
Keeping counselling records	Personal and counselling information	Contract, legitimate interests, legal obligation
Processing sensitive therapeutic information	Special category data	Explicit consent and/or provision of health or social care, where applicable
Managing payments and accounts	Contact and payment information	Contract and legal obligation
Safeguarding or serious risk situations	Personal and special category data	Vital interests, legal obligation, substantial public interest, or safeguarding obligations
Professional supervision	Anonymised or limited client information	Legitimate interests and professional/ethical obligations
Handling complaints or legal claims	Relevant personal information	Legal obligation and legitimate interests

Counselling information often includes special category data. UK GDPR requires an organisation or practitioner to identify both a lawful basis under Article 6 and a separate condition under Article 9 when processing special category data.



6. Confidentiality

Counselling is confidential. This means that what you share in sessions will not usually be shared with anyone else.

However, confidentiality is not absolute. There are some situations where I may need to share information, including:

- If there is a serious risk of harm to you or someone else
- If there is a safeguarding concern involving a child, young person, or vulnerable adult
- If I am legally required to disclose information
- If disclosure is necessary for the prevention or detection of serious crime
- If I need to respond to a court order or legal requirement
- If there is a serious medical emergency
- If I need to seek professional guidance in relation to risk, ethics, or legal responsibilities

Where possible, I will aim to discuss this with you before sharing information. However, in urgent or high-risk situations, I may need to act without your consent.

7. Couples Counselling, Confidentiality and Notes

In couples counselling, notes may relate to both individuals and the relationship. I will not share couples counselling notes with one party or with anyone else, without the permission of both parties, unless I am legally or ethically required to do so. This includes situations involving safeguarding, serious risk of harm, or legal obligations. (Please see details in section 6)

8. Children and Young People

When JKH Counselling works with children or young people, personal information will be handled carefully and in line with safeguarding, confidentiality, and data protection responsibilities.

Children and young people have privacy and confidentiality rights. However, information may need to be shared if there is a safeguarding concern, risk of harm, or legal requirement.

Where appropriate, parents or carers may be involved in practical arrangements, but the young person's confidentiality will be respected as far as possible.

9. Professional Supervision

As part of safe and ethical counselling practice, I attend regular professional supervision. During supervision, I may discuss aspects of my client work to ensure I am practising safely and effectively. Your identity will not normally be disclosed. Information shared in supervision is kept to the minimum necessary and is treated confidentially by the supervisor.



10. Notes and Counselling Records

I may keep brief notes or records relating to your counselling. These may include:

- Your contact details
- Assessment or intake information
- Session dates
- Brief session notes
- Risk assessments, where relevant
- Copies of forms, agreements, or correspondence
- Payment records

These records help me provide safe and consistent support.

11. How Long I Keep Your Information

I will only keep your personal information for as long as necessary.

JKH Counselling will usually keep counselling records for 7 years after counselling ends. Where counselling is provided to a child or young person under the age of 18, their counselling records will be kept securely until 7 years after their 18th birthday. This means records will usually be retained until the client reaches the age of 25.

After this period, records will be securely deleted or destroyed, unless there is a legal, safeguarding, insurance or professional reason to keep them longer.

Financial records may be kept for the period required by tax and accounting rules.

12. How Your Information Is Stored

Your information may be stored securely using:

- Password-protected electronic files
- Encrypted devices or secure cloud storage
- Secure practice management software
- Locked storage for paper documents
- Secure email or communication systems, where possible

I take reasonable steps to protect your information from unauthorised access, loss, misuse, alteration, or disclosure.

13. Sharing Your Information

Your personal information will not be sold or shared for marketing purposes.

I may share limited information with:

- My professional supervisor
- GP, emergency services, or safeguarding services, where necessary
- Professional or legal advisers, where required
- Insurance providers, in the event of a complaint or claim



- Payment providers, where payments are processed online
- Website, email, booking, or practice management service providers
- HMRC or accounting professionals, where required for financial records

Any third-party service providers are expected to handle data securely and only use it for the purpose of providing their service.

14. Email, Phone, Text, and Online Communication

I may communicate with you by email, phone, text, or video call, depending on what we agree. If online counselling is offered, I will use a secure platform where possible and will discuss privacy and confidentiality considerations with you before sessions begin.

Please be aware that no method of digital communication can be guaranteed to be completely secure. I will take reasonable steps to protect your privacy, but you should avoid sending highly sensitive information by email or text unless necessary.

15. Payments

If you make payments for counselling, I may collect or process information relating to:

- Payment amount
- Payment date
- Invoice details
- Bank transfer reference
- Online payment confirmation

I do not store full card details. Payment records may need to be retained for accounting, tax, and legal purposes.

16. Your Data Protection Rights

Under UK data protection law, you have rights over your personal information. These may include:

- The right to be informed about how your data is used
- The right to access a copy of your personal information
- The right to ask for inaccurate information to be corrected
- The right to ask for your information to be erased in certain circumstances
- The right to restrict processing in certain circumstances
- The right to object to certain types of processing
- The right to data portability in certain circumstances
- The right to withdraw consent, where consent is the lawful basis

The right to erasure is not absolute and only applies in certain circumstances. I may need to verify your identity before responding to a request.

To exercise your rights, please contact: **Email:** contact.jkhcounselling@gmail.com



17. Subject Access Requests

You have the right to request a copy of the personal information I hold about you.

I will usually respond within one month of receiving your request, unless the request is complex or further information is needed.

There may be situations where I cannot provide all information, for example couples counselling where disclosure would affect another person's rights, confidentiality, safeguarding, or legal obligations.

18. Emergencies and Safeguarding

JKH Counselling is not an emergency service.

If there is an immediate risk to life or safety, you should contact emergency services by calling **999** or attend your nearest A&E.

If I become aware of a serious risk of harm to you or someone else, I may need to share relevant information with appropriate services, such as a GP, crisis team, emergency services, or safeguarding authority.

19. Data Breaches

If a data breach occurs that is likely to affect your rights or freedoms, I will take appropriate steps to manage the breach.

Where required, I will report the breach to the Information Commissioner's Office and inform affected individuals.

20. Complaints

If you have concerns about how your personal information has been handled, please contact me first so I can try to resolve the issue.

Contact:

contact.jkhcounselling@gmail.com

You also have the right to complain to the Information Commissioner's Office, the UK regulator for data protection.

21. Changes to This Privacy Policy

This Privacy Policy may be updated from time to time to reflect changes in law, professional guidance, or how JKH Counselling operates.

The latest version will be available on this website.